# DumbPhone Lock — Launch Copy (Ready to Paste)

All links include UTM tracking. Just copy, paste, post.

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## Reddit Post 1: r/nosurf

**Title:** I built an app that turns your iPhone into a dumb phone (without buying a $400 Light Phone)

**Body:** I've been lurking here for a while. Like most of you, I've tried everything — deleting apps, Screen Time limits, grayscale mode, putting my phone in another room. Nothing stuck. I'd always find a way back to the scroll.

The tipping point was when I realized I was averaging 5+ hours of screen time a day. That's 76 days a year staring at my phone. I felt sick.

I didn't want to buy a Light Phone because I still need maps, banking, Uber, etc. I just wanted my iPhone to stop being a dopamine slot machine.

So I started building DumbPhone Lock. It's an iOS app that:

- Blocks apps you choose (social media, entertainment, whatever) using Apple's actual Screen Time API — not just a reminder you can dismiss
- Gives you a clean, minimal launcher with just the essentials (phone, messages, calendar, weather)
- Has presets: Social Media mode, Deep Work mode, Nuclear mode (blocks everything)
- Adds intentional friction if you try to unlock early

It's not done yet, but I'm looking for people who'd actually use something like this. I set up a waitlist to gauge interest before I invest more time into it.

If this sounds useful: https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=nosurf

No cost, no spam. Just want to know if this solves a real problem for people here or if I'm building something nobody wants.

Would love your honest feedback.

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## Reddit Post 2: r/digitalminimalism

**Title:** Instead of buying a dumb phone, I'm building an app to make my iPhone dumb on demand

**Body:** Cal Newport's work changed how I think about technology. But the practical implementation has always been the hard part. You can't just throw away your smartphone if you need it for work, navigation, communication.

What I wanted was a toggle. Smart when I need it, dumb when I don't.

So I'm building DumbPhone Lock — an iOS app that uses Apple's Screen Time API to actually block apps (not just send you an ignorable notification). You pick what stays accessible, set a duration, and lock. Your phone becomes a tool instead of a trap.

The key insight: it's not about willpower. Screen Time limits fail because you can dismiss them with one tap. DumbPhone Lock uses the same API parents use to lock their kids' phones. You literally can't access blocked apps.

Still in development, but I'm collecting early interest to make sure I'm building something people actually want before going further.

Waitlist (free, no spam): https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=digitalminimalism

Curious what this community thinks. Would you use something like this? What features would matter most to you?

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# Reddit Post 3: r/productivity

**Title:** It takes 23 minutes to refocus after a distraction. I'm building an app to eliminate the distraction entirely.

**Body:** We all know the stat: it takes an average of 23 minutes to fully refocus after a distraction. And the average person checks their phone 96 times a day.

Do the math and it's terrifying. Most of us never reach a real flow state because our phone interrupts us before we get there.

I tried Screen Time limits, app timers, focus modes. They all have the same fatal flaw — you can bypass them instantly. One tap and you're back to scrolling.

So I'm building DumbPhone Lock. It uses Apple's FamilyControls API (the same one parents use to lock their kids' phones) to actually prevent app access during focus sessions. Not a gentle nudge. An actual lock.

Features:

- One-tap lock for selected apps
- Presets: Social Media, Deep Work, Nuclear (everything blocked)
- Timed sessions (15 min to all day)
- Minimal launcher showing only essential apps
- Intentional friction to unlock early (you have to really want to quit)

Still building it. I'm collecting early interest to validate demand.

Free waitlist: https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=productivity

What features would make this a must-have for your workflow?

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# Reddit Post 4: r/dumbphones

**Title:** I want a dumb phone but need maps, banking, and Uber. So I'm building a "dumb mode" for iPhone.

**Body:** I see this conversation all the time here: "I want a dumb phone but I can't give up [maps/banking/Uber/work apps]."

Same. I don't need a new device. I need my existing phone to stop being so damn addicting.

I'm building DumbPhone Lock — it turns your iPhone into a dumb phone on demand. You pick exactly which apps stay accessible (phone, messages, maps, banking, whatever you need) and everything else gets locked using Apple's Screen Time API.

Think of it as a Light Phone that lives inside your iPhone:

- $0-5 instead of $299
- Use your existing phone and plan
- Keep the apps you actually need
- Toggle dumb mode on/off anytime
- Uses the same blocking tech parents use for kids' phones — can't just dismiss it

Still in development. Collecting early interest to see if there's real demand.

Waitlist: https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=dumbphones

Would this solve the problem for you, or is there something about a separate device that matters more?

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# Twitter/X Thread

**Tweet 1 (Hook):** Your phone steals 4.5 hours of your life every day.

That's 68 days per year.

I'm building an app to stop it. Here's what I'm making and why:

**Tweet 2:** The problem isn't willpower. It's design.

Instagram, TikTok, Twitter — they hire PhDs to make their apps addictive. You're fighting a billion-dollar algorithm with a Screen Time popup you can dismiss in one tap.

That's not a fair fight.

**Tweet 3:** I tried everything:

- Deleting apps (redownloaded within days)
- Screen Time limits (hit "ignore" every time)
- Grayscale mode (got used to it)
- Putting my phone in another room (went and got it)

Nothing works because nothing actually PREVENTS access.

**Tweet 4:** So I'm building DumbPhone Lock.

It uses Apple's FamilyControls API — the same system parents use to lock their kids' phones — to actually block apps on your iPhone.

Not a reminder. Not a timer. A real lock.

**Tweet 5:** How it works:

1. Pick apps to block (or use presets: Social Media, Deep Work, Nuclear)
2. Set a duration
3. Tap lock

Your phone becomes a tool: calls, texts, maps, calendar. Nothing else.

**Tweet 6:** "Just buy a Light Phone"

A Light Phone costs $299, needs its own plan, and can't do maps/banking/Uber.

DumbPhone Lock: free, uses your existing iPhone, keeps essential apps, toggles on/off.

**Tweet 7:** Want to unlock early? You can — but the app adds intentional friction. Confirmation dialogs. A cooling off period.

It's designed to make giving up feel like quitting on yourself.

**Tweet 8:** I'm building this in public. Early access members get:

- First beta access
- Direct input on features
- Launch pricing

Join the waitlist (free): https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=twitter&utm_medium=thread&utm_campaign=launch

**Tweet 9:** If you know someone who needs to put their phone down, share this thread.

If you have ideas for features, reply. I'm building this for people like us.

# Instagram Reel Caption

I built an app that turns your iPhone into a dumb phone 📱➡️

No more doom-scrolling. No more wasted hours. Just the apps you actually need.

DumbPhone Lock uses Apple's Screen Time API to ACTUALLY block apps — not just a reminder you can dismiss.

Link in bio to join the waitlist.

#digitalminimalism #dumbphone #productivity #focusmode #screentime #dopaminedetox #deepwork #nosurf #minimalism #iphonehacks

https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=reel&utm_campaign=launch

# TikTok Caption

Turn your iPhone into a dumb phone in one tap 🔒

Screen Time limits are a joke. This app actually locks you out.

Waitlist link in bio — it's free.

#dumbphone #digitalminimalism #screentime #productivity #dopaminedetox #phonefree #focusmode #deepwork #nosurf #lightphone

https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=tiktok&utm_medium=video&utm_campaign=launch

# Hacker News — Show HN

**Title:** Show HN: DumbPhone Lock – Turn your iPhone into a dumb phone on demand

**Body:** I built an iOS app that uses Apple's FamilyControls/ManagedSettings APIs to block distracting apps during focus sessions.

The core insight: Screen Time limits don't work because users can dismiss them instantly. FamilyControls actually prevents app access — the same mechanism Apple provides for parental controls.

Features:

- Select apps to block individually or by category
- Presets (Social Media, Deep Work, Nuclear)
- Minimal launcher UI showing only allowed apps

- Timed sessions (15 min to unlimited)
- Intentional friction for early unlock

Tech stack: SwiftUI, FamilyControls, ManagedSettings, DeviceActivity APIs. Requires iOS 16+.

Still in development. Looking for early feedback and interest before investing in the Apple Developer Program ($99 for FamilyControls entitlement).

Waitlist: https://marceausolutions.com/dumbphone?utm_source=hackernews&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=launch

Would love technical feedback on the approach. The main limitation is FamilyControls requires the paid developer account — exploring whether there's a way to achieve similar blocking without it.

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This page has DumbPhone Lock as the featured (gold) link at the top, plus your coaching and other links below.